



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY
CONTINUING EDUCATION PROGRAMME (CEP)
EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

EDU 211: INTRODUCTION TO RESEARCH METHODS

AUGUST 2024 SESSION

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer Question ONE and any other TWO.

Question One

- a) Explain three characteristics of educational research. (3 marks)
- b) Differentiate between qualitative and quantitative research. (3 marks)
- c) Describe the function of theory in research. (2 marks)
- d) Explain 4 sources of literature review. (4 marks)
- e) Explain any two methods you would use to determine the sample size of a research study (4 marks)
- f) Describe any 4 sampling techniques in research (8 marks)
- g) State any one advantage and one disadvantage of a questionnaire (2 marks)
- h) State why its important to disseminate research findings (1 mark)
- i) Explain the difference between research design and research methodology (2 marks)

Question Two

- a) Describe the components of a research proposal. (15 marks)
- b) Using a title of your choice, describe steps on how you would conduct literature review. (5 marks)

Question Three

You have excelled in your teaching career after graduating and have been appointed as a director in charge of education in an arid and semi-arid County where girls drop out of school due to early marriages. You are expected to conduct a study that will inform the nature of intervention they will take to mitigate the problem in the County.

- a) Formulate a suitable title for your study. (2 marks)
- b) State three objectives that will guide your study. (3 marks)
- c) Briefly explain the problem that you will be investigating in order to address that study concerned. (3 marks)
- d) Draw a suitable conceptual framework showing how your study variables will be interplaying. (6 marks)
- e) Explain how data from each objective will be analyzed. (6 marks)

Question Four

A researcher conceptualized a study and developed some instruments that were to be used to collect the data. The data were to be collected in three countries targeting senior people in management positions.

- a) Identify two instruments that can be used to collect the data and explain the suitability. (4 marks)
- b) Explain three reliability techniques that could be used to check internal consistency of the instruments. (6 marks)
- c) Discuss five reasons why it will be important for the researcher to pilot the instrument. (10 marks)

Question Five

- a) Explain 3 sources of a research problem (3 marks)
- b) Describe 2 Ethical concerns in research (2 marks)
- c) You have realized that for some years the performance of the form four English examinations has been declining in your county. Explain 5 appropriate data collection methods you would use to address the problem. (15 marks)

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KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

**EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ENVIRONMENTAL
EDUCATION**

EDU 211: INTRODUCTION TO RESEARCH METHODS

2ND SEMESTER 2023/2024

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer question one and any other two questions.

SECTION 1: 30 MARKS

Question 1

- a. Explain three characteristics of an educational research. (3 marks)
- b. Differentiate between qualitative and quantitative research (4 marks)
- c. What is the function of theory in research? (2 marks)
- d. Identify four sources of literature review. (2 marks)
- e. Explain THREE major components of a research proposal. (6 marks)
- f. Describe any two sampling techniques in research. (4 marks)
- g. Explain the difference between research methods and research methodology (2 marks)
- h. Explain any two methods you would use to determine the sample size of a research study. (4 marks)
- i. State one advantages and one disadvantages of a questionnaire (2 marks)
- j. Why is it important to disseminate research findings. (1 mark)

SECTION TWO: 30 MARKS

2. Imagine you are a researcher commissioned to investigate the, "Role of social media on individuals' mental well-being."

- a. Elaborate 3 importance of theoretical frameworks (3 marks)

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INVOLVEMENT IN ANY EXAMINATION IRREGULARITY SHALL LEAD TO DISCONTINUATION

- b. Discuss how theoretical framework can be integrated with Literature reviewed(12 marks)
3. Students from Kenyatta University are planning to carry out a study in the neighbouring primary schools.
- a. Suggest an appropriate topic for the study. (1 mark)
- b. Describe four sources of literature they are likely to review in preparation for the field work. (8 marks)
- c. Describe 3 instruments the students are likely to use for data collection(6 marks)
4. Using relevant examples, discuss the probability sampling techniques available for educational researchers. (15 marks)
5. a. Using suitable examples to education, discuss 5 reasons why many researchers are unable to select suitable designs for their research problems? (10 marks)
- b. State an educational research problem and from it, explain independent, dependent and extraneous/confounding/intervening variables. (5 marks)

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KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

CONTINUING EDUCATION PROGRAMME (CEP) 2023/2024

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

EDU 211: INTRODUCTION TO RESEARCH METHODS

AUGUST 2023 SESSION

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer Question ONE and any other TWO questions.

QUESTION ONE (20 MARKS)

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow:

Oscar is a second year undergraduate student at Kusoma University, studying for a Bachelor of Education (B.Ed) degree. As part of the programme, he is taking an introductory course in Research methods. In an assignment, he is interested in understanding whether there are differences in the achievement scores of secondary students who are learning Mathematics using computer-assisted learning and those who attend physical lessons only. Based on a belief that the computer technology can facilitate learning of certain concepts in mathematics, Oscar decides to focus on Form one students in secondary schools in his sub-county. These schools are distributed as follows:

No. of schools in Waruku sub-county

WARD	No. of Public	No. of Private
Nyariki	3	1
Ekuminicha	5	2
Kahuruko	7	2
Wamumu	2	1
Giagatika	6	1

- i) State a possible research question to guide Oscar's proposed research study.
(1 mark)
- ii) State a possible research objective for the proposed study.
(1 mark)
- iii) a) Why do researchers sample (objects, events, or people) in a research study?
State TWO reasons.
(2 marks)

- b) Explain the sampling method you would propose that Oscar adopts to select the Form one students that he can study. (3 marks)

- iv) Identify an appropriate tool/instrument that Oscar can use to collect information on the students achievement in Mathematics based on the teaching technology. Explain your choice (3 marks)

- v) Identify and explain who is most appropriate person in the study to respond to the research questions. (3 marks)

- vi) After Oscar conducts his study, the results are as follows:

County Ward	Public Schools		Private Schools	
	$\bar{X}$ CAL	$\bar{X}$ Trad	$\bar{X}$ CAL	$\bar{X}$ Trad
Nyariki	72	62	81	60
Ekuminatia	75	65	84	62
Kahuruko	70	60	78	58
Wamumu	68	58	82	62
Giagatika	71	51	80	63
Total Students (N)	250	250	100 405	100 395

The mean score in mathematics is represented by $\bar{X}$. Two groups of students in each school, whether public or private, took a Mathematics test after two lessons on In equalities. One group was taught with the aid of a computer programme while the other group was taught by the traditional lecture method. The mean score of the group taught with the aid of a computer programme is represented by $\bar{X}$ CAL while the mean score for the group taught by the lecture method by $\bar{X}$ Trad.

- (a) Calculate the overall mean of the Mathematics scores for the two groups for both public schools and private schools for the sub-country and present it as follows:

$$\bar{X}_{CAL}^{Pub}$$

$$\bar{X}_{Trad.}^{Pub}$$

$$\bar{X}_{CAL}^{Private}$$

$$\bar{X}_{Trad.}^{Private}$$

- (b) Make a brief comment on the mean scores obtained. (1 mark)

- vii) Identify a possible beneficiary from the findings Oscar obtained from the study. (1 mark)

- viii) Identify a possible method that Oscar can use to share the findings from this study. (1 mark)

QUESTION TWO

- (i) For each of the following statements, identify the independent variable and the dependent variable.
- (a) Is there a relationship between feelings of social acceptance and the size of a family among girls in middle school?
- Independent variable (IV) (1 mark)
- Dependent variable (DV) (1 mark)
- (b) Does pre-school behaviour predict a fourth grade pupil's attendance of school and achievement in cognitive tests?
- Independent variable (IV) 1 (1 mark)
- Independent variable (IV) 2 (1 mark)
- Dependent variable (DV) (1 mark)
- (ii) Describe TWO instruments/tools you would use to collect data for a study you wish to conduct. (6 marks)
- (iii) List any 4 types of statistics that researchers use to analyze data collected in a research study. (4 marks)

QUESTION THREE

- (i) List FIVE steps in the process of research. (5 marks)
- (ii) Explain THREE reasons why researchers review literature for research studies they intend to carry out. (6 marks)
- (iii) For each of the following research topics, indicate a suitable research design that can be used to conduct the study from the list provided after the table.

Research Topic	Research Approach	Research Method
1. To what extent are gender equity initiatives being supported by the county government of Humanitans? 2. A study of the You Only Live Once subculture among student in Kumenya University 3. Participation of women in University leadership in Kunyata, 2000 – 2023 4. Influence of small versus large group instruction on students achievement in Mathematics among Form 1 students, Kusoma County		

Designs: Experimental, Survey, Case study, Historical

QUESTION FOUR (15 MARKS)

- (i) Explain THREE reasons why a researcher needs to adhere to ethical guidelines while preparing for, conducting and reporting a research study. (9 marks)
- (ii) What is an abstract in a research proposal or report? (1 mark)
- (iii) List FIVE key sections of a research report. (5 marks)

QUESTION FIVE (15 MARKS)

For your experience, interest and or other possible sources, identify a potential research area and topic you would wish to investigate and then do the following:

- (i) Write the title of the proposed study. (2 marks)
- (ii) Explain why you think the study would be necessary to conduct. (3 marks)
- (iii) Explain how you would carry out the proposed study and subsequently report the finding from the study. (10 marks)

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